FICTIONAL TEST PACKET. Not a real application.

Applicant's Name: Taylor Brooks

STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

I am applying to MSAI because my statistics degree taught me to fit a model and my internship taught me that fitting it is the easy part. At an insurance internship I rebuilt a churn notebook that a team had been copying forward. I put the split in the right place and wrote down the features. The team used the notebook the rest of the summer. I did not design a new model.

I want Northwestern's program for the machine learning core and for a project with more consequence than a summer notebook. I am interested in how claims models get checked, not in a particular lab. I have had probability, mathematical statistics, regression, and one applied machine learning course. My grades in the theory courses were B's. I am straightforward about that.

I will need the first-year courses. I am applying because I want them, and because I can already do a careful split. I do not have a publication.

EDUCATION

Undergraduate institution: University of Iowa
Degree: B.S. Statistics, 2024
Cumulative GPA: 3.51

RESEARCH

No university research appointment. Internship analysis described under work experience.

PROJECTS

Churn notebook, internship, summer 2023. I replaced a random split that had leaked the renewal month. I documented the features in a README the team kept. I did not deploy a model.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Actuarial intern, Prairie Mutual, Iowa City, May 2023 to August 2023. After graduation, data coordinator at the same office, September 2024 to the present. I check monthly reports. It is not a modeling job.

HONORS AND AWARDS

None beyond the degree.

LETTERS OF RECOMMENDATION

Letter 1. Supervisor Erin Walsh, Prairie Mutual. "Taylor fixed a notebook the team had been copying, wrote down what it did, and left it in a state we still open. I recommend Taylor for further study. Taylor was reliable this summer."

Letter 2. Supervisor Mark Dalton, Prairie Mutual. "Taylor has been on time and pleasant since joining the reporting team. The monthly checks are accurate. I do not have a view of Taylor's technical research. Taylor is a fine colleague."